

Zeyi Liao

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🔌 Research Interests

I am broadly interested in AI agents, aiming to build helpful *yet aligned* agent systems that benefit humanity. AI models have crossed a critical capability threshold for general-purpose work; my next mission is to harness the rogue AI and build trustworthy autonomy.

🎓 Education

- **The Ohio State University** (Advisor: **Huan Sun**) Aug. 2023 – Present
Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering
- **University of Southern California** (Advisor: **Xiang Ren**) Aug. 2021 – May. 2023
M.S in Electronic and Computer Engineering
- **Beijing Jiaotong University** Aug. 2016 – May. 2020
B.S in Electronic Engineering

🧩 Experience

- **Research Intern**, Neocognition Apr. 2026 – Present
Host: **Xiang Deng**
Topic: Continual learning, agent harness, long-horizon computer-use agents
- **Research Intern**, Microsoft Research (Redmond) May. 2025 – Aug. 2025
Host: **Ahmed Awadallah**, **Yadong Lu**
Topic: Computer-use agents, visual grounding

📖 Publications (selected, see full list on 🎓)

* means equal contribution

- **RedTeamCUA: Realistic Adversarial Testing of Computer-Use Agents in Hybrid Web-OS Environments**
Zeyi Liao*, Jaylen Jones*, Linxi Jiang*, Eric Fosler-Lussier, Yu Su, Zhiqiang Lin, Huan Sun
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026. [PDF] **Oral (1.5%)**
‣ The only safety benchmark adopted in **Qwen-CUA**.
- **EIA: Environmental Injection Attack on Generalist Web Agents for Privacy Leakage**
Zeyi Liao*, Lingbo Mo*, Chejian Xu, Mintong Kang, Jiawei Zhang, Chaowei Xiao, Yuan Tian, Bo Li, Huan Sun
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2025. [PDF]
‣ Selected as course material for **UCSD CSE 291: LLM Security**.
‣ Incorporated into UC Berkeley RDI's **SuperRed**.
- **Amplegcg: Learning a universal and transferable generative model of adversarial suffixes for jailbreaking both open and closed llms**
Zeyi Liao, Huan Sun
Conference on Language Modeling (COLM), 2024. [PDF]
‣ Discussed in **Daniel Paleka's AI safety newsletter**.
‣ Follow-up work: **AmpleGCG-plus** (🔥 X thread).

- **Agent Learning via Early Experience**

Kai Zhang, Xiangchao Chen*, Bo Liu*, Tianci Xue*, Zeyi Liao*, Zhihan Liu*, Xiyao Wang*, Yuting Ning*, Zhaorun Chen*, Xiaohan Fu, Jian Xie, Yuxuan Sun, Boyu Gou, Qi Qi, Zihang Meng, Jianwei Yang, Ning Zhang, Xian Li, Ashish Shah, Dat Huynh, Hengduo Li, Zi Yang, Sara Cao, Lawrence Jang, Shuyan Zhou, Jiacheng Zhu, Huan Sun, Jason Weston, Yu Su, Yifan Wu

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2026. [\[PDF\]](#)

- **Beyond Clicking: A Step Towards Generalist GUI Grounding via Text Dragging**

Zeyi Liao, Yadong Lu, Boyu Gou, Huan Sun, Ahmed Awadallah

Preprint on Arxiv, 2025. [\[PDF\]](#)

- **WebGuard: Building a Generalizable Guardrail for Web Agents**

Boyuan Zheng, Zeyi Liao, Scott Salisbury, Zeyuan Liu, Michael Lin, Qinyuan Zheng, Zifan Wang, Xiang Deng, Dawn Song, Huan Sun, Yu Su

Preprint on Arxiv, 2025. [\[PDF\]](#)

- **AdvAgent: Controllable Blackbox Red-teaming on Web Agents**

Chejian Xu, Mintong Kang, Jiawei Zhang, Zeyi Liao, Lingbo Mo, Mengqi Yuan, Huan Sun, Bo Li

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2025 [\[PDF\]](#)

- **Joint Demonstration and Preference Learning Improves Policy Alignment with Human Feedback**

Chenliang Li, Siliang Zeng*, Zeyi Liao*, Jiaxiang Li, Dongyeop Kang, Alfredo Garcia, Mingyi Hong

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2025. [\[PDF\]](#)

Service

- **Reviewer:** COLM, CVPR, EMNLP, ICLR, IEEE TNNLS, NeurIPS

- **Teaching Assistant:** CSE 3521 Survey of Artificial Intelligence I @ OSU Aug. 2023 – Jan. 2024

Awards

- **Master Honor Student**, University of Southern California

Aug. 2022

- **First Class Scholarship**, Beijing Jiaotong University

Aug. 2020/2019/2018

- **Merit Student**, Beijing Jiaotong University

Aug. 2018/2017